

# Confirmatory Factor Analysis II

## Introduction to Structural Equation Modeling



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# Outline

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Model Estimation

Model Fit

Model Complexity

Model Identification

- Under-Identified Models

- Over-Identified Models

Example



# MODEL ESTIMATION



# Model-Implied Statistics

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Most statistical estimation algorithms operate by minimizing the difference between two key reference points:

1. The *model-implied* statistics/predictions/fitted values
  - The sufficient statistics implied by the structure of your model.
  - Predicted/fitted values produced by your model.
2. The *observed* statistics/values
  - The sufficient statistics calculated from the observed data.
  - The raw outcome values from your dataset.

The predictions/implied statistics produced by a good model must be simpler than the analogous quantities in the observed data.

- A model that exactly replicates the observed data is overfitting.
- The inferences from such models won't generalize to the population.

# Model-Implied Statistics

---

You should already be familiar with this idea from OLS regression.

- The fitted values are the model implied statistics.

$$\hat{Y}_n = \hat{\beta}_0 + \sum_{p=1}^P \hat{\beta}_p X_{n,p}$$

- The raw outcome variable,  $Y$ , contains the observed values.
- Minimize the difference between  $\hat{Y}$  and  $Y$  to estimate the model.

$$RSS = \sum_{n=1}^N (Y_n - \hat{Y}_n)^2$$



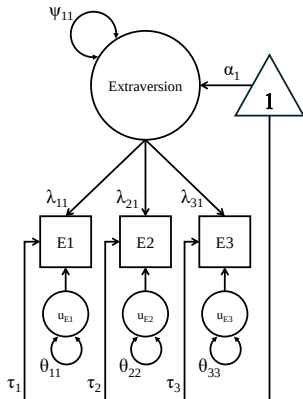
# Hypothesized Model

We'll use this toy model to sketch out the intuition for maximum likelihood estimation of CFA models.

$$\alpha = [\alpha_1] \quad \Psi = [\psi_{11}]$$

$$\tau = \begin{bmatrix} \tau_1 \\ \tau_2 \\ \tau_3 \end{bmatrix} \quad \Lambda = \begin{bmatrix} \lambda_{11} \\ \lambda_{21} \\ \lambda_{31} \end{bmatrix}$$

$$\Theta = \begin{bmatrix} \theta_{11} & & \\ 0 & \theta_{22} & \\ 0 & 0 & \theta_{33} \end{bmatrix}$$



# Parameters → Implied Statistics

The parameter matrices define the model-implied mean vector,  $\hat{\mu}$ , and covariance matrix,  $\hat{\Sigma}$ , via the following formulas.

$$\Sigma = \Lambda \Psi \Lambda^T + \Theta$$

$$\mu = \tau + \Lambda \alpha$$

By expanding these formulas, we can see how the model reproduces each mean, variance, and covariance.

$$\hat{\mu} = \begin{bmatrix} \tau_1 + \lambda_{11}\alpha_1 \\ \tau_2 + \lambda_{22}\alpha_1 \\ \tau_3 + \lambda_{33}\alpha_1 \end{bmatrix} \quad \hat{\Sigma} = \begin{bmatrix} \lambda_{11}\psi_{11}\lambda_{11} + \theta_{11} & & \\ \lambda_{11}\psi_{11}\lambda_{21} & \lambda_{21}\psi_{11}\lambda_{21} + \theta_{22} & \\ \lambda_{11}\psi_{11}\lambda_{31} & \lambda_{21}\psi_{11}\lambda_{31} & \lambda_{31}\psi_{11}\lambda_{31} + \theta_{33} \end{bmatrix}$$

# Model-Implied Statistics for Estimation

The estimating algorithm chooses values for  $\alpha$ ,  $\tau$ ,  $\Psi$ , and  $\Lambda$  that minimize the differences between the model-implied statistics,  $\{\hat{\mu}, \hat{\Sigma}\}$ , and the sufficient statistics calculated from the observed data,  $\{\bar{\mathbf{Y}}, \mathbf{S}\}$ .

$$\hat{\mu} = \begin{bmatrix} \tau_1 + \lambda_{11}\alpha_1 \\ \tau_2 + \lambda_{22}\alpha_1 \\ \tau_3 + \lambda_{33}\alpha_1 \end{bmatrix} \quad \hat{\Sigma} = \begin{bmatrix} \lambda_{11}\psi_{11}\lambda_{11} + \theta_{11} & & \\ \lambda_{11}\psi_{11}\lambda_{21} & \lambda_{21}\psi_{11}\lambda_{21} + \theta_{22} & \\ \lambda_{11}\psi_{11}\lambda_{31} & \lambda_{21}\psi_{11}\lambda_{31} & \lambda_{31}\psi_{11}\lambda_{31} + \theta_{33} \end{bmatrix}$$

$$\bar{\mathbf{Y}} = \begin{bmatrix} \bar{y}_1 \\ \bar{y}_2 \\ \bar{y}_3 \end{bmatrix} \quad \mathbf{S} = \begin{bmatrix} \text{var}(y_1) & & \\ \text{cov}(y_2, y_1) & \text{var}(y_2) & \\ \text{cov}(y_3, y_1) & \text{cov}(y_3, y_2) & \text{var}(y_3) \end{bmatrix}$$





# Optimization: Intuition

---

We can formulate the familiar OLS objective as an abstract optimization problem as follows.

$$f(\beta_0, \beta_1, \dots, \beta_p) = \arg \min_{\beta_0, \beta_1, \dots, \beta_p} \|Y - \hat{Y}\|$$

Applying the same idea to our CFA optimization problem, we get the following formulation.

$$f(\Lambda, \Psi) = \arg \min_{\Lambda, \Psi} \|\text{Cov}(\mathbf{Y}) - \hat{\Sigma}\|$$

$$f(\tau, \alpha) = \arg \min_{\tau, \alpha} \|\bar{\mathbf{Y}} - \hat{\mu}\|$$



# Optimization: Objective Function

---

In OLS regression, we minimize the residual sum of squares (RSS).

$$RSS = \sum_{n=1}^N (Y_n - \hat{Y}_n)^2$$

In CFA, we can estimate the model by minimizing the *model deviance*.

$$D_M = -2 \left[ \ell(\hat{\Sigma}, \hat{\mu}) - \ell(\mathbf{S}, \bar{\mathbf{Y}}) \right]$$

Where,  $\ell(\cdot)$  denotes the *loglikelihood* function.

- $\ell(\hat{\Sigma}, \hat{\mu})$  returns the loglikelihood value for our estimated model.
- $\ell(\mathbf{S}, \bar{\mathbf{Y}})$  returns the loglikelihood value for the *saturated model*.

# Optimization: Loglikelihood Functions

The loglikelihood function is a model-based distance metric.

- Derived from the assumed data distribution (i.e., multivariate normal)
- Quantifies the "chances" of your estimated model having generated the observed data

$$\ell(\hat{\Sigma}, \hat{\mu}) = -\frac{K}{2} \ln(2\pi) - \frac{1}{2} \ln |\hat{\Sigma}| - \frac{1}{2} \sum_{n=1}^N (Y_n - \hat{\mu})^T \hat{\Sigma}^{-1} (Y_n - \hat{\mu})$$

Say we fit two models,  $M_a$  and  $M_b$ , to the same dataset. If  $\ell(M_a)$  is closer to zero, we know that  $M_a$  represents the data better than  $M_b$  does.

- $M_a$ 's implied statistics are closer to the observed sufficient statistics.
- $M_a$ 's parameters are more plausible, given the data.

# MODEL FIT



# Model Fit: Intuition

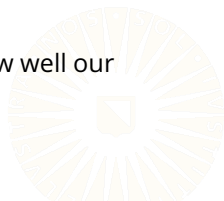
---

We want a plausible, parsimonious, and useful model.

1. Our model should make theoretical sense.
2. Our model's implied statistics should closely align with the observed sufficient statistics.
3. Our model should be no more complex than necessary.

We can use *model fit statistics* to evaluate the second and third criteria.

- Model fit statistics transform  $\hat{D}_M$  into interpretable, comparable, scale-free distance measures.
- These indices give us practical tools for evaluating how well our model represents the data.



# Different Ways to Quantify Fit

---

When evaluating model fit, we need to consider classes of model.

1. Our estimated model.
2. The *independence model*
  - The worst possible model
  - All item associations are fixed to zero
3. The *saturated model*
  - The "best" possible model
  - All possible associations are estimated
  - Perfectly reproduces the observed sufficient statistics



# Independence Model

---

```
indMod <- '  
A1 ~~ A1  
A2 ~~ A2  
A3 ~~ A3  
O1 ~~ O1  
O2 ~~ O2  
O3 ~~ O3  
'  
  
indOut <- cfa(indMod, data = bfi)
```

# Independence Model

---

```
partSummary(indOut, 1:4)
```

lavaan 0.6-19 ended normally after 20 iterations

|                            |        |       |
|----------------------------|--------|-------|
| Estimator                  | ML     |       |
| Optimization method        | NLMINB |       |
| Number of model parameters | 6      |       |
|                            | Used   | Total |
| Number of observations     | 2696   | 2800  |

Model Test User Model:

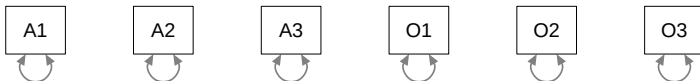
|                      |          |
|----------------------|----------|
| Test statistic       | 2053.922 |
| Degrees of freedom   | 15       |
| P-value (Chi-square) | 0.000    |



# Independence Model

```
lavInspect(indOut, "cov.ov")
```

|    | A1    | A2    | A3    | O1    | O2    | O3    |
|----|-------|-------|-------|-------|-------|-------|
| A1 | 1.984 |       |       |       |       |       |
| A2 | 0.000 | 1.377 |       |       |       |       |
| A3 | 0.000 | 0.000 | 1.708 |       |       |       |
| O1 | 0.000 | 0.000 | 0.000 | 1.271 |       |       |
| O2 | 0.000 | 0.000 | 0.000 | 0.000 | 2.431 |       |
| O3 | 0.000 | 0.000 | 0.000 | 0.000 | 0.000 | 1.485 |



# Saturated Model

---

```
satMod <- '  
A1 ~~ A1  
A2 ~~ A1 + A2  
A3 ~~ A1 + A2 + A3  
O1 ~~ A1 + A2 + A3 + O1  
O2 ~~ A1 + A2 + A3 + O1 + O2  
O3 ~~ A1 + A2 + A3 + O1 + O2 + O3  
'  
  
satOut <- cfa(satMod, data = bfi)
```

# Saturated Model

---

```
partSummary(satOut, 1:4)
```

```
lavaan 0.6-19 ended normally after 36 iterations
```

|                            |        |       |
|----------------------------|--------|-------|
| Estimator                  | ML     |       |
| Optimization method        | NLMINB |       |
| Number of model parameters | 21     |       |
|                            | Used   | Total |
| Number of observations     | 2696   | 2800  |

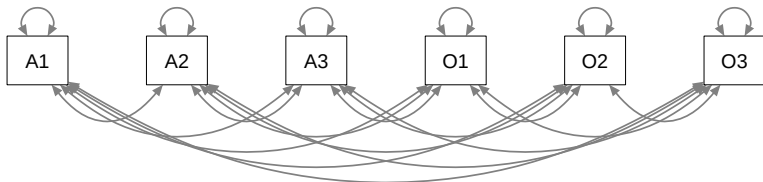
```
Model Test User Model:
```

|                    |       |
|--------------------|-------|
| Test statistic     | 0.000 |
| Degrees of freedom | 0     |

# Saturated Model

```
lavInspect(satOut, "cov.ov")
```

|    | A1     | A2    | A3     | O1     | O2     | O3    |
|----|--------|-------|--------|--------|--------|-------|
| A1 | 1.984  |       |        |        |        |       |
| A2 | -0.567 | 1.377 |        |        |        |       |
| A3 | -0.493 | 0.751 | 1.708  |        |        |       |
| O1 | 0.013  | 0.174 | 0.213  | 1.271  |        |       |
| O2 | 0.172  | 0.024 | -0.004 | -0.382 | 2.431  |       |
| O3 | -0.098 | 0.234 | 0.357  | 0.544  | -0.514 | 1.485 |



# Measurement Structure

---

We don't estimate any measurement structure in the independence model or in the saturated model.

```
lavInspect(indOut, "est")$lambda
```

```
A1  
A2  
A3  
O1  
O2  
O3
```

```
lavInspect(indOut, "est")$psi
```

```
<0 x 0 matrix>
```

```
lavInspect(satOut, "est")$lambda
```

```
A1  
A2  
A3  
O1  
O2  
O3
```

```
lavInspect(satOut, "est")$psi
```

```
<0 x 0 matrix>
```

# Different Ways to Quantify Fit

---

We can conceptualize model fit comparisons in two ways.

## 1. *Absolute Fit*

- How well does the model reproduce the observed sufficient statistics?
- How close is our model to the best possible model?
- Compare our model to the *saturated model*.

## 2. *Relative/Incremental/Comparative Fit*

- How much better does our model perform than some poorer baseline model?
- How much improvement do we achieve over the worst possible model?
- Compare our model to the *independence model*.



# $\chi^2$ Statistic

---

The  $\chi^2$  statistic is the most fundamental model fit statistic.

- Absolute fit statistic
- Derived directly from the optimized value of the objective function
- Allows rigorous hypothesis tests
- Basis for most other fit indices

$$\chi^2 = D_M$$

$$\chi^2 = N \times F_{ML}$$

This statistic follows a  $\chi^2$  distribution with  $df = Q - P$  (i.e., the same DF as the estimated model).



# Example Model

---

```
library(lavaan)
library(psych)

mod1 <- '
agree =~ A1 + A2 + A3
open  =~ O1 + O2 + O3
'

out1 <- cfa(mod1, data = bfi)
```



# Example Model

---

```
partSummary(out1, 1:4)
```

lavaan 0.6-19 ended normally after 40 iterations

|                            |        |
|----------------------------|--------|
| Estimator                  | ML     |
| Optimization method        | NLMINB |
| Number of model parameters | 13     |

|                        | Used | Total |
|------------------------|------|-------|
| Number of observations | 2696 | 2800  |

Model Test User Model:

|                      |         |
|----------------------|---------|
| Test statistic       | 120.283 |
| Degrees of freedom   | 8       |
| P-value (Chi-square) | 0.000   |

# Problems with $\chi^2$

---

The  $\chi^2$  statistic test for *exact fit*:

$$H_0 : \hat{\Sigma} = \mathbf{S}$$

$$H_1 : \hat{\Sigma} \neq \mathbf{S}$$

This hypothesis is perfectly valid, but it isn't a very interesting or useful for real-world data analysis.

- The  $\chi^2$  will almost always reject the null hypothesis.
- With a large enough sample, the null hypothesis must be rejected for any model other than the exact data generating model.
- We'll reject perfectly good models because of substantively trivial deviations from the population model.

We don't want a model that exactly replicates the sufficient statistics.

- The true data generating model is almost certainly too complex to have any practical utility.

# Approximate Fit Indices

---

In practice, we won't use the  $\chi^2$  test to directly evaluate model fit. We'll use *approximate fit indices* (mostly) derived from the  $\chi^2$ .

- We have many (maybe too many) options.
- **lavaan** 0.6-19 provides 28 approximate fit measures for a basic CFA.

We'll focus on three complementary and well-balanced indices.

- Root Mean Squared Error of Approximation (RMSEA)
- Comparative Fit Index (CFI)
- Standardized Root Mean Squared Residual (SRMR)



# RMSEA

---

The RMSEA is an *absolute fit index* that evaluates deviations from *close fit*.

$$\text{RMSEA} = \sqrt{\max \left[ \frac{\chi^2 - df}{N \times df}, 0 \right]}$$



# CFI

---

The CFI is a normed *incremental fit index*.

$$CFI = 1 - \frac{\max [(\chi^2 - df), 0]}{\max [(\chi_0^2 - df_0), (\chi^2 - df), 0]}$$

Assuming the ordinary situation where  $\chi^2 \geq df$ , and the baseline model fits worse than our target model, we can simplify the CFI formula.

$$CFI = 1 - \frac{\chi^2 - df}{\chi_0^2 - df_0}$$



# SRMR

---

$$\text{SRMR} = \sqrt{\frac{\sum_{i=1}^M \sum_{j=1}^i \left[ \frac{s_{ij} - \hat{\sigma}_{ij}}{s_i s_j} \right]^2}{Q}}$$



# Example: Target Model

We can use the `fitMeasures()` function to get model fit statistics.

```
fit1 <- fitMeasures(out1)
```

```
head(fit1, 22) |> round(3)
```

|            |                   |             |                 |
|------------|-------------------|-------------|-----------------|
| npar       | fmin              | chisq       | df              |
| 13.000     | 0.022             | 120.283     | 8.000           |
| pvalue     | baseline.chisq    | baseline.df | baseline.pvalue |
| 0.000      | 2053.922          | 15.000      | 0.000           |
| cfi        | tli               | nnfi        | rfi             |
| 0.945      | 0.897             | 0.897       | 0.890           |
| nfi        | pnfi              | ifi         | rni             |
| 0.941      | 0.502             | 0.945       | 0.945           |
| logl       | unrestricted.logl | aic         | bic             |
| -26114.771 | -26054.629        | 52255.542   | 52332.236       |
| ntotal     | bic2              |             |                 |
| 2696.000   | 52290.931         |             |                 |

# Example: Target Model

```
tail(fit1, -22) |> round(3)
```

|                       |                   |                |
|-----------------------|-------------------|----------------|
| rmsea                 | rmsea.ci.lower    | rmsea.ci.upper |
| 0.072                 | 0.061             | 0.084          |
| rmsea.ci.level        | rmsea.pvalue      | rmsea.close.h0 |
| 0.900                 | 0.001             | 0.050          |
| rmsea.notclose.pvalue | rmsea.notclose.h0 | rmr            |
| 0.138                 | 0.080             | 0.068          |
| rmr_nomean            | srmr              | srmr_bentler   |
| 0.068                 | 0.039             | 0.039          |
| srmr_bentler_nomean   | crmr              | crmr_nomean    |
| 0.039                 | 0.046             | 0.046          |
| srmr_mplus            | srmr_mplus_nomean | cn_05          |
| 0.039                 | 0.039             | 348.577        |
| cn_01                 | gfi               | agfi           |
| 451.298               | 0.986             | 0.963          |
| pgfi                  | mfi               | ecvi           |
| 0.376                 | 0.979             | 0.054          |



# Example: Independence Model

---

```
indFit <- fitMeasures(indOut) |> as.list()
fit1    <- as.list(fit1)

indFit$chisq
[1] 2053.922

fit1$baseline.chisq
[1] 2053.922

indFit$df
[1] 15

fit1$baseline.df
[1] 15
```

# Example: Saturated Model

---

The saturated model has perfect fit because it perfectly reproduces the observed sufficient statistics.

```
fitMeasures(satOut, c("chisq", "df", "rmsea", "cfi", "srmr"))
```

| chisq | df | rmsea | cfi | srmr |
|-------|----|-------|-----|------|
| 0     | 0  | 0     | 1   | 0    |

# Manually Calculating $\chi^2$

---

```
llSat <- logLik(satOut) # saturated model loglikelihood
ll1  <- logLik(out1)   # target model loglikelihood

# Manually calculate the chi-squared stat
-2 * (ll1 - llSat) |> as.numeric()

[1] 120.2832

# Compare to lavaan's version
fit1$chisq

[1] 120.2832
```

# Manually Calculating CFI

---

```
chisq1 <- fit1$chisq
df1    <- fit1$df
chisq0 <- fit1$baseline.chisq
df0    <- fit1$baseline.df

# Manually calculate the CFI
1 - ((chisq1 - df1) / (chisq0 - df0))

[1] 0.9449301

# Compare to lavaan's version
fit1$cfi

[1] 0.9449301
```

# Manually Calculating RMSEA

---

```
n <- fit1$ntotal  
  
# Manually calculate the RMSEA  
sqrt((chisq1 - df1) / (n * df1))  
  
[1] 0.07215267  
  
# Compare to lavaan's version  
fit1$rmsea  
  
[1] 0.07215267
```

# Manually Calculating SRMR

---

```
M <- 6 # No. of observed variables
Q <- M * (M + 1) / 2 # No. of unique elements in S

# Model-implied covariance matrix
sHat <- inspect(out1, "sigma")

# Observed covariance matrix
sObs <- inspect(out1, "sampstat")$cov

# Observed standard deviations
se <- sqrt(diag(sObs))
```

# Manually Calculating SRMR

---

```
# Sum of squared standardized residuals
x <- 0
for(i in 1:M) {
  for(j in 1:i) {
    x <- x + ( (sObs[i, j] - sHat[i, j]) / (se[i] * se[j]) )^2
  }
}

# Root mean of the above = SRMR
sqrt(x / Q) |> as.numeric()

[1] 0.03850419

# Compare to lavaan's version
fit1$srmr

[1] 0.03850419
```

# MODEL COMPLEXITY



# DF & Complexity

---

# Parsimony

---

# MODEL IDENTIFICATION

# Identifying Constraints

---

We must fix some parameters to identify the model.

- For each construct, we need  $df \geq 0$ .
- If the construct has three or more indicators:
  - Fix one parameter in the covariance model.
  - Fix one parameter in the mean model.
- If the construct has two indicators:
  - Fix an additional parameter in the covariance model.
- If the construct has only one indicator:
  - Cannot define a latent factor.

# Under-Identified: Unconstrained Model

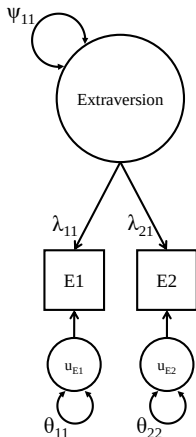
$$\Psi = [\psi_{11}]$$

$$\Lambda = \begin{bmatrix} \lambda_{11} \\ \lambda_{21} \end{bmatrix}$$

$$\Theta = \begin{bmatrix} \theta_{11} & \\ \mathbf{0} & \theta_{22} \end{bmatrix}$$

$$Q = \frac{2(2+1)}{2} = 3$$

$$\begin{aligned} df &= Q - P \\ &= 3 - 5 = -2 \end{aligned}$$



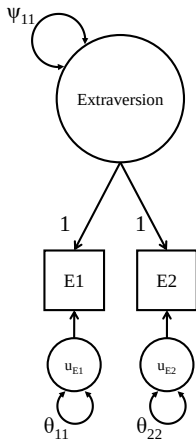
# Under-Identified: Marker-Variable

$$\Psi = [\psi_{11}]$$

$$\Lambda = \begin{bmatrix} 1 \\ 1 \end{bmatrix}$$

$$\Theta = \begin{bmatrix} \theta_{11} & \\ 0 & \theta_{22} \end{bmatrix}$$

$$\begin{aligned} df &= Q - P \\ &= 3 - 3 = 0 \end{aligned}$$



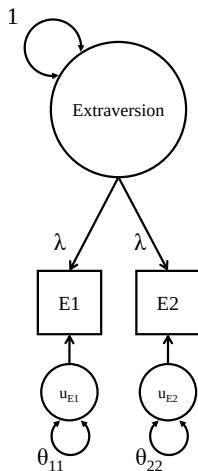
# Under-Identified: Fixed-Factor

$$\Psi = [1]$$

$$\Lambda = \begin{bmatrix} \lambda \\ \lambda \end{bmatrix}$$

$$\Theta = \begin{bmatrix} \theta_{11} & \\ 0 & \theta_{22} \end{bmatrix}$$

$$\begin{aligned} df &= Q - P \\ &= 3 - 3 = 0 \end{aligned}$$



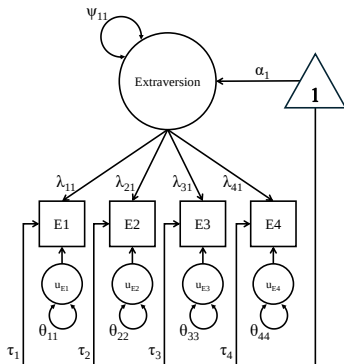
# Over-Identified Models

What happens when we have four (or more) indicators?

With 4 indicators, our model contains 14 parameters:

- Four factor loadings
- Four residual variances
- Four item intercepts
- One latent mean
- One latent variance

$$Q = \frac{4(4+1)}{2} + 4 = 14$$
$$df = 14 - 14 = 0$$





# Over-Identified Models

---

With 5 indicators, we have 17 model parameters:

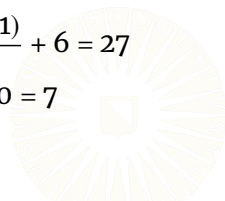
- Five factor loadings
- Five residual variances
- Five item intercepts
- One latent mean
- One latent variance

$$Q = \frac{5(5+1)}{2} + 5 = 20$$
$$df = 20 - 17 = 3$$

With 6 indicators, we have 20 model parameters:

- Six factor loadings
- Six residual variances
- Six item intercepts
- One latent mean
- One latent variance

$$Q = \frac{6(6+1)}{2} + 6 = 27$$
$$df = 27 - 20 = 7$$



# Over-Identified Models

With four indicators, we automatically have  $df \geq 0$  without imposing any scaling constraints.

- Can we directly estimate the unconstrained model?

```
mod1 <- '  
fun =~ Q77 + Q84 + Q170 + Q196  
'
```

```
fit1 <- lavaan(mod1,  
               data      = sapi,  
               auto.var  = TRUE,  
               meanstructure = TRUE,  
               int.ov.free = TRUE,  
               int.lv.free = TRUE)
```

```
Warning: lavaan->lav_model_vcov():  
  Could not compute standard errors! The information matrix could not be  
  inverted. This may be a symptom that the model is not identified.
```

Hmmm...I guess not.

# Over-Identified Models

---

```
partSummary(fit1, 1:4)
```

```
lavaan 0.6-19 ended normally after 13 iterations
```

|                            |        |       |
|----------------------------|--------|-------|
| Estimator                  | ML     |       |
| Optimization method        | NLMINB |       |
| Number of model parameters | 14     |       |
|                            | Used   | Total |
| Number of observations     | 970    | 1000  |

```
Model Test User Model:
```

|                    |        |
|--------------------|--------|
| Test statistic     | 58.017 |
| Degrees of freedom | 0      |

# Over-Identified Models

```
partSummary(fit1, 7:8)
```

Latent Variables:

|        | Estimate | Std.Err | z-value | P(> z ) |
|--------|----------|---------|---------|---------|
| fun =~ |          |         |         |         |
| Q77    | 0.824    | NA      |         |         |
| Q84    | 0.578    | NA      |         |         |
| Q170   | 0.479    | NA      |         |         |
| Q196   | 0.619    | NA      |         |         |

Intercepts:

|       | Estimate | Std.Err | z-value | P(> z ) |
|-------|----------|---------|---------|---------|
| .Q77  | 3.574    | NA      |         |         |
| .Q84  | 3.232    | NA      |         |         |
| .Q170 | 3.955    | NA      |         |         |
| .Q196 | 3.803    | NA      |         |         |
| fun   | 0.000    | NA      |         |         |

# Over-Identified Models

---

```
partSummary(fit1, 9)
```

Variances:

|       | Estimate | Std.Err | z-value | P(> z ) |
|-------|----------|---------|---------|---------|
| .Q77  | 0.491    | NA      |         |         |
| .Q84  | 0.760    | NA      |         |         |
| .Q170 | 0.703    | NA      |         |         |
| .Q196 | 0.370    | NA      |         |         |
| fun   | 1.012    | NA      |         |         |

# Over-Identified Models

---

In the above example, the data contain enough information to define our model parameters, but that's not enough.

- We still need scaling constraints.
- The estimation algorithm needs an anchor point from which to extrapolate the relative values of the model parameters.
- Without any scaling constraints, an infinite number of parameter matrices will produce the same  $\hat{\mu}$  and  $\hat{\Sigma}$ .
- An infinite number of solutions are equally good.

```
## Fit a model to get some example parameters:
mod1 <- '
fun    =~ Q77 + Q84 + Q170 + Q196
liked =~ Q44 + Q63 + Q76 + Q98
'

fit1 <- cfa(mod1, data = sapi, effect.coding = TRUE)
```

# Over-Identified Models

---

*## Extract the estimated factor loadings and latent covariance matrix:*

```
(lambda <- inspect(fit1, "est")$lambda)
```

```
      fun liked
Q77  1.254 0.000
Q84  0.954 0.000
Q170 0.795 0.000
Q196 0.997 0.000
Q44   0.000 0.764
Q63   0.000 1.155
Q76   0.000 1.133
Q98   0.000 0.949
```

```
(psi <- inspect(fit1, "est")$psi)
```

```
      fun liked
fun    0.399
liked 0.241 0.311
```

# Over-Identified Models

---

```
## Extract the estimated residual variances:
```

```
(theta <- inspect(fit1, "est")$theta)
```

|      | Q77   | Q84   | Q170  | Q196  | Q44   | Q63   | Q76   | Q98   |
|------|-------|-------|-------|-------|-------|-------|-------|-------|
| Q77  | 0.548 |       |       |       |       |       |       |       |
| Q84  | 0.000 | 0.727 |       |       |       |       |       |       |
| Q170 | 0.000 | 0.000 | 0.687 |       |       |       |       |       |
| Q196 | 0.000 | 0.000 | 0.000 | 0.364 |       |       |       |       |
| Q44  | 0.000 | 0.000 | 0.000 | 0.000 | 0.662 |       |       |       |
| Q63  | 0.000 | 0.000 | 0.000 | 0.000 | 0.000 | 0.807 |       |       |
| Q76  | 0.000 | 0.000 | 0.000 | 0.000 | 0.000 | 0.000 | 0.966 |       |
| Q98  | 0.000 | 0.000 | 0.000 | 0.000 | 0.000 | 0.000 | 0.000 | 0.469 |



# Over-Identified Models

---

```
## Manually compute the model-implied covariance matrix:
```

```
(sigma <- lambda %*% psi %*% t(lambda) + theta)
```

|      | Q77   | Q84   | Q170  | Q196  | Q44   | Q63   | Q76   | Q98   |
|------|-------|-------|-------|-------|-------|-------|-------|-------|
| Q77  | 1.176 |       |       |       |       |       |       |       |
| Q84  | 0.477 | 1.090 |       |       |       |       |       |       |
| Q170 | 0.398 | 0.303 | 0.940 |       |       |       |       |       |
| Q196 | 0.499 | 0.380 | 0.316 | 0.761 |       |       |       |       |
| Q44  | 0.231 | 0.175 | 0.146 | 0.183 | 0.843 |       |       |       |
| Q63  | 0.349 | 0.265 | 0.221 | 0.277 | 0.275 | 1.223 |       |       |
| Q76  | 0.342 | 0.260 | 0.217 | 0.272 | 0.269 | 0.407 | 1.365 |       |
| Q98  | 0.287 | 0.218 | 0.182 | 0.228 | 0.226 | 0.341 | 0.335 | 0.750 |

# Over-Identified Models

---

```
## Randomly sample an arbitrary scaling factor:  
(a <- runif(1, 1, 2))  
  
[1] 1.524314  
  
## Rescale all factor loadings by a factor of a:  
(lambda2 <- lambda * a)  
  
      fun liked  
Q77  1.911 0.000  
Q84  1.454 0.000  
Q170 1.212 0.000  
Q196 1.520 0.000  
Q44  0.000 1.164  
Q63  0.000 1.760  
Q76  0.000 1.727  
Q98  0.000 1.447
```

# Over-Identified Models

```
## Rescale the latent covariance matrix by a factor of (1 / a^2):
(psi2 <- psi / a^2)

      fun liked
fun    0.172
liked 0.104 0.134

## Compute the model-implied covariance matrix using the rescaled parameters:
(sigma2 <- lambda2 %*% psi2 %*% t(lambda2) + theta)

      Q77    Q84   Q170   Q196    Q44    Q63    Q76    Q98
Q77    1.176
Q84    0.477 1.090
Q170   0.398 0.303 0.940
Q196   0.499 0.380 0.316 0.761
Q44    0.231 0.175 0.146 0.183 0.843
Q63    0.349 0.265 0.221 0.277 0.275 1.223
Q76    0.342 0.260 0.217 0.272 0.269 0.407 1.365
Q98    0.287 0.218 0.182 0.228 0.226 0.341 0.335 0.750
```

# Over-Identified Models

---

```
## Compare the two model-implied covariance matrices:
```

```
all.equal(sigma, sigma2)
```

```
[1] TRUE
```

```
## Repeat the experiment 100 times:
```

```
out <- rep(NA, 100)
```

```
for(i in 1:100) {
```

```
  a <- runif(1, 1, 2)
```

```
  lambda2 <- lambda * a
```

```
  psi2 <- psi / a^2
```

```
  sigma2 <- lambda2 %*% psi2 %*% t(lambda2) + theta
```

```
  out[i] <- all.equal(sigma, sigma2)
```

```
}
```

```
## Always the same result?
```

```
all(out)
```

```
[1] TRUE
```

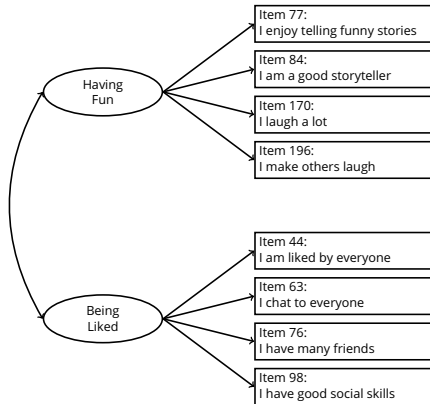
# EXAMPLE

# CFA of Extraversion Items

Suppose we hypothesize two distinct dimensions of extraversion underlying 8 of the SAPI items.

1. Having Fun
2. Being Liked by Others

We'll define our measurement model as the two-factor CFA shown to the right.



# Example: Marker Variable

---

Load the SAPI data.

```
dataDir <- "data"
sapi <- read.table(here::here(dataDir, "sapi.txt"),
                  header = TRUE,
                  na.strings = "-999")
```

Specify the **lavaan** model syntax for the SAPI extraversion CFA.

```
mod1 <- '
fun    =~ Q77 + Q84 + Q170 + Q196
liked =~ Q44 + Q63 + Q76 + Q98
'
```

Use the `cfa()` function to estimate the model.

```
library(lavaan)
out1 <- cfa(mod1, data = sapi)
```

# Example: Marker Variable

```
partSummary(out1, 1:4)
```

lavaan 0.6-19 ended normally after 30 iterations

|                            |        |       |
|----------------------------|--------|-------|
| Estimator                  | ML     |       |
| Optimization method        | NLMINB |       |
| Number of model parameters | 17     |       |
|                            | Used   | Total |
| Number of observations     | 959    | 1000  |

Model Test User Model:

|                      |         |
|----------------------|---------|
| Test statistic       | 130.193 |
| Degrees of freedom   | 19      |
| P-value (Chi-square) | 0.000   |



# Example: Marker Variable

```
partSummary(out1, 5:7)
```

Parameter Estimates:

| Standard errors                  | Standard   |
|----------------------------------|------------|
| Information                      | Expected   |
| Information saturated (h1) model | Structured |

Latent Variables:

|          | Estimate | Std.Err | z-value | P(> z ) |
|----------|----------|---------|---------|---------|
| fun =~   |          |         |         |         |
| Q77      | 1.000    |         |         |         |
| Q84      | 0.761    | 0.051   | 14.902  | 0.000   |
| Q170     | 0.634    | 0.047   | 13.558  | 0.000   |
| Q196     | 0.795    | 0.046   | 17.381  | 0.000   |
| liked =~ |          |         |         |         |
| Q44      | 1.000    |         |         |         |
| Q63      | 1.512    | 0.147   | 10.278  | 0.000   |
| Q76      | 1.483    | 0.149   | 9.955   | 0.000   |
| Q98      | 1.243    | 0.119   | 10.462  | 0.000   |

# Example: Marker Variable

```
partSummary(out1, 8:9)
```

Covariances:

|        | Estimate | Std.Err | z-value | P(> z ) |
|--------|----------|---------|---------|---------|
| fun ~~ |          |         |         |         |
| liked  | 0.231    | 0.025   | 9.234   | 0.000   |

Variances:

|       | Estimate | Std.Err | z-value | P(> z ) |
|-------|----------|---------|---------|---------|
| .Q77  | 0.548    | 0.038   | 14.389  | 0.000   |
| .Q84  | 0.727    | 0.039   | 18.703  | 0.000   |
| .Q170 | 0.687    | 0.035   | 19.572  | 0.000   |
| .Q196 | 0.364    | 0.025   | 14.731  | 0.000   |
| .Q44  | 0.662    | 0.034   | 19.291  | 0.000   |
| .Q63  | 0.807    | 0.048   | 16.943  | 0.000   |
| .Q76  | 0.966    | 0.054   | 17.931  | 0.000   |
| .Q98  | 0.469    | 0.029   | 16.121  | 0.000   |
| fun   | 0.627    | 0.056   | 11.303  | 0.000   |
| liked | 0.182    | 0.029   | 6.290   | 0.000   |

# Example: Marker Variable

```
inspect(out1, "r2")
```

```
   Q77   Q84  Q170  Q196   Q44   Q63   Q76   Q98  
0.534 0.333 0.268 0.521 0.215 0.340 0.293 0.374
```

```
fitMeasures(out1) |> head(22) |> round(3)
```

|            |                   |             |                 |
|------------|-------------------|-------------|-----------------|
| npar       | fmin              | chisq       | df              |
| 17.000     | 0.068             | 130.193     | 19.000          |
| pvalue     | baseline.chisq    | baseline.df | baseline.pvalue |
| 0.000      | 1574.886          | 28.000      | 0.000           |
| cfi        | tli               | nnfi        | rfi             |
| 0.928      | 0.894             | 0.894       | 0.878           |
| nfi        | pnfi              | ifi         | rni             |
| 0.917      | 0.622             | 0.929       | 0.928           |
| logl       | unrestricted.logl | aic         | bic             |
| -10147.587 | -10082.491        | 20329.175   | 20411.895       |
| ntotal     | bic2              |             |                 |
| 959.000    | 20357.903         |             |                 |

# Example: Marker Variable

```
fitMeasures(out1) |> tail(-22) |> round(3)
```

|                       |                   |                |
|-----------------------|-------------------|----------------|
| rmsea                 | rmsea.ci.lower    | rmsea.ci.upper |
| 0.078                 | 0.066             | 0.091          |
| rmsea.ci.level        | rmsea.pvalue      | rmsea.close.h0 |
| 0.900                 | 0.000             | 0.050          |
| rmsea.notclose.pvalue | rmsea.notclose.h0 | rmr            |
| 0.421                 | 0.080             | 0.042          |
| rmr_nomean            | srmr              | srmr_bentler   |
| 0.042                 | 0.043             | 0.043          |
| srmr_bentler_nomean   | crmr              | crmr_nomean    |
| 0.043                 | 0.049             | 0.049          |
| srmr_mplus            | srmr_mplus_nomean | cn_05          |
| 0.043                 | 0.043             | 223.037        |
| cn_01                 | gfi               | agfi           |
| 267.582               | 0.968             | 0.939          |
| pgfi                  | mfi               | ecvi           |
| 0.511                 | 0.944             | 0.171          |

## Example: Fixed Factor

---

We only need to change one option to implement the fixed-factor method.

- The `std.lv = TRUE` option (i.e., standardized latent variables) applies the appropriate constraints.

```
out2 <- cfa(mod1, data = sapi, std.lv = TRUE)
```

# Example: Fixed Factor

---

```
partSummary(out2, 1:4)
```

lavaan 0.6-19 ended normally after 17 iterations

|                            |        |       |
|----------------------------|--------|-------|
| Estimator                  | ML     |       |
| Optimization method        | NLMINB |       |
| Number of model parameters | 17     |       |
|                            | Used   | Total |
| Number of observations     | 959    | 1000  |

Model Test User Model:

|                      |         |
|----------------------|---------|
| Test statistic       | 130.193 |
| Degrees of freedom   | 19      |
| P-value (Chi-square) | 0.000   |

# Example: Fixed Factor

```
partSummary(out2, 5:7)
```

Parameter Estimates:

| Standard errors                  | Standard   |
|----------------------------------|------------|
| Information                      | Expected   |
| Information saturated (h1) model | Structured |

Latent Variables:

|          | Estimate | Std.Err | z-value | P(> z ) |
|----------|----------|---------|---------|---------|
| fun =~   |          |         |         |         |
| Q77      | 0.792    | 0.035   | 22.606  | 0.000   |
| Q84      | 0.603    | 0.035   | 17.193  | 0.000   |
| Q170     | 0.502    | 0.033   | 15.180  | 0.000   |
| Q196     | 0.630    | 0.028   | 22.308  | 0.000   |
| liked =~ |          |         |         |         |
| Q44      | 0.426    | 0.034   | 12.580  | 0.000   |
| Q63      | 0.644    | 0.040   | 16.071  | 0.000   |
| Q76      | 0.632    | 0.043   | 14.845  | 0.000   |
| Q98      | 0.530    | 0.031   | 16.912  | 0.000   |

# Example: Fixed Factor

```
partSummary(out2, 8:9)
```

Covariances:

|        | Estimate | Std.Err | z-value | P(> z ) |
|--------|----------|---------|---------|---------|
| fun ~~ |          |         |         |         |
| liked  | 0.683    | 0.033   | 20.483  | 0.000   |

Variances:

|       | Estimate | Std.Err | z-value | P(> z ) |
|-------|----------|---------|---------|---------|
| .Q77  | 0.548    | 0.038   | 14.389  | 0.000   |
| .Q84  | 0.727    | 0.039   | 18.703  | 0.000   |
| .Q170 | 0.687    | 0.035   | 19.572  | 0.000   |
| .Q196 | 0.364    | 0.025   | 14.731  | 0.000   |
| .Q44  | 0.662    | 0.034   | 19.291  | 0.000   |
| .Q63  | 0.807    | 0.048   | 16.943  | 0.000   |
| .Q76  | 0.966    | 0.054   | 17.931  | 0.000   |
| .Q98  | 0.469    | 0.029   | 16.121  | 0.000   |
| fun   | 1.000    |         |         |         |
| liked | 1.000    |         |         |         |



# Example: Fixed Factor

```
inspect(out2, "r2")
```

```
      Q77   Q84  Q170  Q196   Q44   Q63   Q76   Q98  
0.534 0.333 0.268 0.521 0.215 0.340 0.293 0.374
```

```
fitMeasures(out2) |> head(22) |> round(3)
```

|            |                   |             |                 |
|------------|-------------------|-------------|-----------------|
| npars      | fmin              | chisq       | df              |
| 17.000     | 0.068             | 130.193     | 19.000          |
| pvalue     | baseline.chisq    | baseline.df | baseline.pvalue |
| 0.000      | 1574.886          | 28.000      | 0.000           |
| cfi        | tli               | nnfi        | rfi             |
| 0.928      | 0.894             | 0.894       | 0.878           |
| nfi        | pnfi              | ifi         | rni             |
| 0.917      | 0.622             | 0.929       | 0.928           |
| logl       | unrestricted.logl | aic         | bic             |
| -10147.587 | -10082.491        | 20329.175   | 20411.895       |
| ntotal     | bic2              |             |                 |
| 959.000    | 20357.903         |             |                 |

# Example: Fixed Factor

```
fitMeasures(out2) |> tail(-22) |> round(3)
```

|                       |                   |                |
|-----------------------|-------------------|----------------|
| rmsea                 | rmsea.ci.lower    | rmsea.ci.upper |
| 0.078                 | 0.066             | 0.091          |
| rmsea.ci.level        | rmsea.pvalue      | rmsea.close.h0 |
| 0.900                 | 0.000             | 0.050          |
| rmsea.notclose.pvalue | rmsea.notclose.h0 | rmr            |
| 0.421                 | 0.080             | 0.042          |
| rmr_nomean            | srmr              | srmr_bentler   |
| 0.042                 | 0.043             | 0.043          |
| srmr_bentler_nomean   | crmr              | crmr_nomean    |
| 0.043                 | 0.049             | 0.049          |
| srmr_mplus            | srmr_mplus_nomean | cn_05          |
| 0.043                 | 0.043             | 223.037        |
| cn_01                 | gfi               | agfi           |
| 267.582               | 0.968             | 0.939          |
| pgfi                  | mfi               | ecvi           |
| 0.511                 | 0.944             | 0.171          |

# Compare Results

---

```
inspect(out1, "est")$lambda - inspect(out2, "est")$lambda
```

```
      fun liked  
Q77  0.208 0.000  
Q84  0.158 0.000  
Q170 0.132 0.000  
Q196 0.165 0.000  
Q44  0.000 0.574  
Q63  0.000 0.868  
Q76  0.000 0.851  
Q98  0.000 0.713
```

```
inspect(out1, "est")$psi - inspect(out2, "est")$psi
```

```
      fun liked  
fun    -0.373  
liked -0.453 -0.818
```

# Compare Results

```
all.equal(fitMeasures(out1), fitMeasures(out2))
```

```
[1] TRUE
```

```
inspect(out1, "r2") - inspect(out2, "r2")
```

| Q77 | Q84 | Q170 | Q196 | Q44 | Q63 | Q76 | Q98 |
|-----|-----|------|------|-----|-----|-----|-----|
| 0   | 0   | 0    | 0    | 0   | 0   | 0   | 0   |

```
inspect(out1, "est")$theta - inspect(out2, "est")$theta
```

|      | Q77 | Q84 | Q170 | Q196 | Q44 | Q63 | Q76 | Q98 |
|------|-----|-----|------|------|-----|-----|-----|-----|
| Q77  | 0   |     |      |      |     |     |     |     |
| Q84  | 0   | 0   |      |      |     |     |     |     |
| Q170 | 0   | 0   | 0    |      |     |     |     |     |
| Q196 | 0   | 0   | 0    | 0    |     |     |     |     |
| Q44  | 0   | 0   | 0    | 0    | 0   |     |     |     |
| Q63  | 0   | 0   | 0    | 0    | 0   | 0   |     |     |
| Q76  | 0   | 0   | 0    | 0    | 0   | 0   | 0   |     |
| Q98  | 0   | 0   | 0    | 0    | 0   | 0   | 0   | 0   |